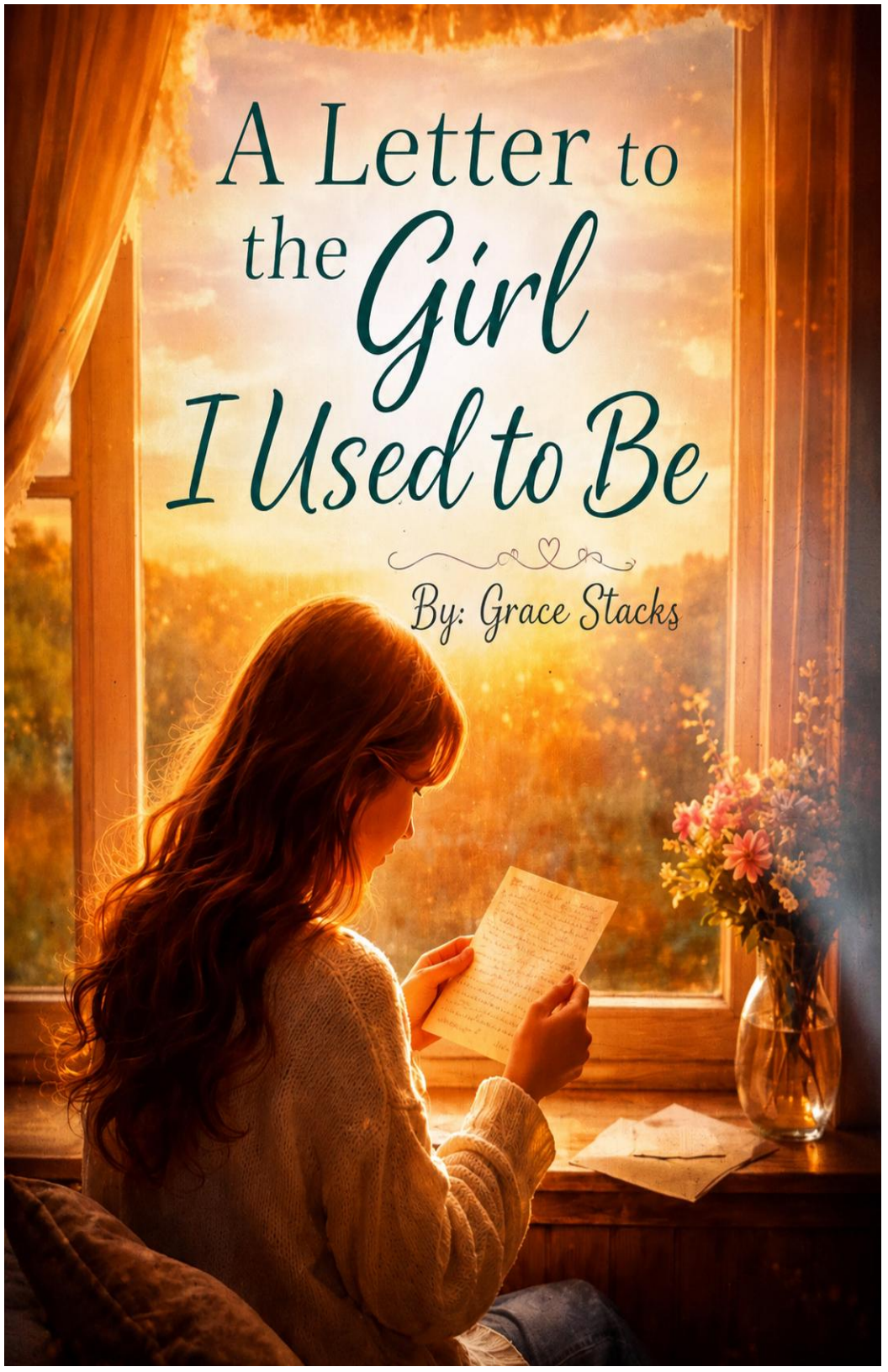

A Letter to the Girl I Used to Be
By: Grace Stacks

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INTRODUCTION

This is a letter to the girl I used to be.

The girl who always felt things more sincerely than most people and would always wind up being insecure wondering if that made her weak.

The girl who had the biggest desire to be confident in herself but also needed reassurance.

The girl who would frequently try to keep herself together while also being weighed down by figuring out how life works.

At times growing up felt awkward and confusing. There were some days I felt very put together and confident, while other days I would doubt everything, my value, my faith, my spot in this huge world. I either had to be accepted or not, because there wasn't another option. I had to belong, I had to be understood, I needed to feel like I was doing things correctly.

Although there were also parts of my story that weren't identical to everyone else's

There were times I carried things I had no clue how to explain to others or even how to carry myself. Seasons and moments in my life where things would take place that put me in a higher place of maturity than I may have been ready for. Experiences that molded me in ways that not everyone around me could see. I learned very early on in my life how to be strong, even when I didn't feel required to. And for a while, I

thought those tougher moments of my story meant something was off put about me.

I decided to write this book because if I ever had the opportunity to sit with my younger self for even a moment, I would never try and alternate her or try to give her exact answers. I would give her these words. I would tell her that the things she experienced and went through has never and will never ruin her, it molded her. The situations that made her different from everyone else, never disqualified her from being loved or heard.

This book is for the individual who feels like they qualify sometimes but feel the opposite at other times. For the individual who is learning who they are and who they are meant to be while also carrying things that they haven't particularly told anyone about. For the individual's story that feels heavier and more challenging than they expected it to feel.

You don't have to relate to every part of my story for this book to be for you. If you've ever felt confused, stressed by emotions, concerned and confused about your faith, or you're scared of blossoming into the wrong version of yourself, you're not alone.

Growing up isn't and has never been easy for me personally. Healing has never been at the snap of a finger. My faith and relationship with God hasn't and doesn't always feel simple. But none of that means you're disqualified from anything. It means you're human.

So this is my letter to the girl I used to be, the one who needed guidance, love, and hope. And if you're reading this and see pieces of yourself in these pages, maybe this letter was meant to find you too.